

ACTS 242 CHURCH OF CHRIST

FOUNDATION GUIDE

A discipleship guide for learning, growing,
and following Jesus Christ

SEVEN LESSONS
EDITION 1 · 2026



2026 CHURCH THEME

ALL ABOUT JESUS

Every lesson in this guide returns to one person. He is the subject of the Scriptures, the head of the church, and the one to whom every response in these pages is owed.

ACTS 242

FOUNDATION GUIDE

A discipleship guide for learning, growing,
and following Jesus Christ

By Acts 242 Church of Christ
Edition 1 (2026)

WELCOME

WELCOME TO ACTS 242

Acts 242 Church of Christ, is a church community committed to living out the pattern found in Scripture.

ACTS 2:42 · NIV

THE FELLOWSHIP OF THE BELIEVERS

⁴² They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching and to fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer.

This verse expresses the heart of who we are and what we desire to become. We want to be a church grounded in the Word of God, shaped by prayer, united in fellowship, and centered on Jesus Christ.

This guide was created to help people know God, understand His truth, and respond in faithful obedience. It is designed for those who are seeking God, learning the foundations of the Christian life, or growing deeper as disciples of Jesus.

Our prayer is that every lesson in this guide will lead people not only to knowledge, but to real transformation. May this book help each reader grow in faith, walk in truth, and live as part of God's people with purpose, conviction, and love.

NOTICE**CHURCH USE NOTICE**

This guide was prepared for the ministry, discipleship, and teaching work of Acts 242 Church of Christ Corporation, operating under the name Acts 242.

Unless otherwise stated, Scripture quotations are from the Holy Bible. Passages marked NIV are quoted from the New International Version; passages marked SUMMARY are the church's own condensed teaching text and should be read alongside an open Bible.

This material may be used, printed, and reproduced for personal study, one on one discipleship, small group gatherings, and church ministry within Acts 242, with proper permission from church leadership.

This guide may not be sold, republished, or distributed for commercial use without written permission from Acts 242.

All lesson content remains subject to review and future revision for teaching clarity, doctrinal consistency, and ministry use.

Acts 242 Church of Christ Corporation
4707 Dr Arcadio Santos Ave, Parañaque, 1700 Metro Manila

2026

METHOD**HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE**

This guide is designed for personal study, one on one discipleship, and small group teaching.

Each lesson begins with the original study material used in our church. The original Scriptures and core teaching points are kept intact. To help readers understand and apply the lessons more clearly, added sections may include notes, explanations, Bible stories, examples, reflection questions, and practical challenges.

As you go through each lesson, read the verses carefully, answer the questions honestly, and take time to pray. Do not rush through the material. The goal is not simply to finish a lesson, but to let God's Word shape your heart, mind, and life.

For the best use of this guide, keep a Bible, a notebook, and a willing heart with you. Some lessons may challenge your beliefs, priorities, or habits. Receive those moments with humility and faith, and let Scripture remain your standard.

This guide is best used with a mentor, disciple maker, or church group, but it may also be used for personal study. Our prayer is that through every page, you will know Jesus more clearly, follow Him more faithfully, and grow in His church.

LEADER'S NOTE

Every page marked LEADER'S NOTE is written for the person teaching. Read them before the study, not during it.

CONTENTS

TABLE OF CONTENTS

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to Acts 242	i
Church Use Notice	ii
How to Use This Guide	iii
Table of Contents	iv
The Seven Lessons	v

LESSONS

LESSON ONE	1
Seeking God	
LESSON TWO	18
Word of God	
LESSON THREE	32
Discipleship	
LESSON FOUR	48
Kingdom of God	
LESSON FIVE	65
Light and Darkness	
LESSON SIX	87
Church	
LESSON SEVEN	104
Cross	

REFLECTION AND COMMITMENT

Closing Reflection	126
Next Steps	127
Scripture Index	128

THE ARC

THE SEVEN LESSONS

The lessons build on one another. Each one is coloured on the page edge so a group can find it quickly, and each one ends where the next one begins.

01

Seeking God

Whether you are pursuing God at all.

02

Word of God

What decides truth once you begin.

03

Discipleship

What following Him actually costs.

04

Kingdom of God

Whose rule you are living under.

05

Light and Darkness

How a person is saved, and when.

06

Church

The people you are saved into.

07

Cross

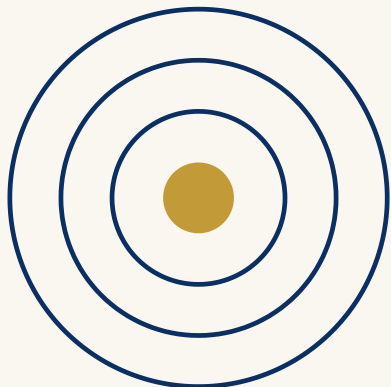
What it cost Him, and what you owe.

SEEKING GOD

Pursuing a Relationship with God with All
Your Heart

PURPOSE

To determine what it means to pursue a
relationship with God with all our
hearts.



PURPOSE

To determine what it means to pursue a relationship with God with all our hearts.

MAIN QUESTION

What are you looking for in life?
What are you pursuing with all your heart?

INTRO

Every person is searching for something.

- Some pursue success.
- Some pursue happiness.
- Some pursue relationships.
- Some pursue purpose.

But the most important question is this: **Are you seeking God?**

This lesson will help you understand what it truly means to seek God, and how that decision can change your life.

YOUR ANSWER

BEFORE WE OPEN THE BIBLE

What are you pursuing with all your heart?

Write the two or three things that actually get your time, money, and attention this year.

ON A SCALE OF 1-10, HOW MUCH EFFORT DO YOU GIVE TO SEEKING GOD?

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	----

LEADER'S NOTE

Ask for the number before you teach anything, and write it down. You will come back to it on the reflection page, and the gap between the number they gave and the answer they give at the end is the lesson.

SCRIPTURE

BLESSED ARE THOSE WHO SEEK HIM

PSALM 119:1-2 · NIV

ALEPH א

¹ Blessed are those whose ways are blameless, who walk according to the law of the Lord. ² Blessed are those who keep his statutes and seek him with all their heart—

“BLESSED”

joyful, highly favored

“BLAMELESS”

living what is right

UNDERSTAND

- To seek God, you must seek His Word with all your heart.
- We seek God by knowing and obeying His Word.
- When you seek God fully, the result is not just temporary happiness, but a deeper and lasting joy.

SCRIPTURE

DO NOT WORRY

MATTHEW 6:25-34 · NIV

²⁵ “Therefore I tell you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat or drink; or about your body, what you will wear. Is not life more than food, and the body more than clothes? ²⁶ Look at the birds of the air; they do not sow or reap or store away in barns, and yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not much more valuable than they? ²⁷ Can any one of you by worrying add a single hour to your life? ²⁸ “And why do you worry about clothes? See how the flowers of the field grow. They do not labor or spin. ²⁹ Yet I tell you that not even Solomon in all his splendor was dressed like one of these. ³⁰ If that is how God clothes the grass of the field, which is here today and tomorrow is thrown into the fire, will he not much more clothe you—you of little faith? ³¹ So do not worry, saying, ‘What shall we eat?’ or ‘What shall we drink?’ or ‘What shall we wear?’ ³² For the pagans run after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them. ³³ But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well. ³⁴ Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Each day has enough trouble of its own.

MATTHEW 6:25-34 • IN SHORT

Jesus taught His disciples not to worry about food, drink, or clothing. He pointed to the birds and the flowers, which God feeds and clothes, and asked why they would doubt that God would care for them. He said their Father knows what they need, and told them to seek first His kingdom and His righteousness.

Many people do not seek God because they don't believe He has the power to change their lives.

What are some areas in your life that you are tempted to worry about?

READ MATTHEW 6:25-34**UNDERSTAND**

Worry often reveals what we value most. We worry about:

- finances
- career
- relationships

UNDERSTAND**SEEK FIRST HIS KINGDOM**

What does it mean to “seek first His kingdom and His righteousness”?

What does God promise if you do?

To “seek first His kingdom” means:

- putting God above your plans
- trusting God with your future
- obeying God even when it is difficult

KEY TRUTH

When God is first, everything else finds its proper place.

SCRIPTURE**GOD IS NOT FAR FROM ANY ONE OF US****ACTS 17:24-28 · NIV**

²⁴ “The God who made the world and everything in it is the Lord of heaven and earth and does not live in temples built by human hands. ²⁵ And he is not served by human hands, as if he needed anything. Rather, he himself gives everyone life and breath and everything else. ²⁶ From one man he made all the nations, that they should inhabit the whole earth; and he marked out their appointed times in history and the boundaries of their lands. ²⁷ God did this so that they would seek him and perhaps reach out for him and find him, though he is not far from any one of us. ²⁸ ‘For in him we live and move and have our being.’ As some of your own poets have said, ‘We are his offspring.’

ACTS 17:24–28 · IN SHORT

Paul told the men of Athens that the God who made the world does not live in temples built by human hands, and is not served by human hands as if He needed anything. From one man He made all nations and marked out their times and places, so that people would seek Him and perhaps reach out for Him and find Him — though He is not far from any one of us.

What is God doing to develop a relationship with people? Why does God go through all this trouble?

READ ACTS 17:24–28

So that people may seek Him and have a genuine relationship with Him even though there is no guarantee that they will.

TRUTH

God is near. The question is not whether God is present. The question is whether you are seeking Him.

SCRIPTURE IN THE SPIRIT AND IN TRUTH

JOHN 4:23-24 · NIV

²³ Yet a time is coming and has now come when the true worshipers will worship the Father in the Spirit and in truth, for they are the kind of worshipers the Father seeks. ²⁴ God is spirit, and his worshipers must worship in the Spirit and in truth.”

What does a true worshiper of God do?

READ JOHN 4:23-24

UNDERSTAND

WORSHIP IS NOT JUST

- singing
- attending church
- emotional experience

TRUE WORSHIP IS

- sincere, from the heart
- grounded in truth
- consistent in life

God is not looking for perfect people. He is looking for people who are real and willing to seek Him honestly.

SCRIPTURE

WHEN YOU SEEK ME WITH ALL YOUR HEART

JEREMIAH 29:11–13 · NIV

¹¹ For I know the plans I have for you,” declares the Lord, “plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future. ¹² Then you will call on me and come and pray to me, and I will listen to you. ¹³ You will seek me and find me when you seek me with all your heart.

UNDERSTAND

In the same way, we can be held captive by sin, and God wants to set us free. God wants to give us hope and a future, but to discover these plans, we must first draw near to Him. The only way to do that is to seek Him with all our hearts.

Many people want direction, purpose, a better future. God’s promise is clear. This is not casual interest. This is full pursuit.

LEADER’S NOTE

Verse 11 is quoted often and on its own. Read 12 and 13 with it — the promise has a condition attached, and the condition is the point of this lesson.

BIBLE EXAMPLE

A CASE STUDY OF SOMEONE SEEKING GOD

ACTS 8:26–39 • NIV

²⁶ Now an angel of the Lord said to Philip, “Go south to the road—the desert road—that goes down from Jerusalem to Gaza.” ²⁷ So he started out, and on his way he met an Ethiopian eunuch, an important official in charge of all the treasury of the Kandake (which means “queen of the Ethiopians”). This man had gone to Jerusalem to worship, ²⁸ and on his way home was sitting in his chariot reading the Book of Isaiah the prophet. ²⁹ The Spirit told Philip, “Go to that chariot and stay near it.”

³⁰ Then Philip ran up to the chariot and heard the man reading Isaiah the prophet. “Do you understand what you are reading?” Philip asked.

³¹ “How can I,” he said, “unless someone explains it to me?” So he invited Philip to come up and sit with him.

³² This is the passage of Scripture the eunuch was reading:

“He was led like a sheep to the slaughter,
and as a lamb before its shearer is silent,
so he did not open his mouth.

³³ In his humiliation he was deprived of justice.
Who can speak of his descendants?
For his life was taken from the earth.”

³⁴ The eunuch asked Philip, “Tell me, please, who is the prophet talking about, himself or someone else?” ³⁵ Then Philip began with that very passage of Scripture and told him the good news about Jesus.

³⁶ As they traveled along the road, they came to some water and the eunuch said, “Look, here is water. What can stand in the way of my being baptized?” ³⁸ And he gave orders to stop the chariot. Then both Philip and the eunuch went down into the water and Philip baptized him. ³⁹ When they came up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord suddenly took Philip away, and the eunuch did not see him again, but went on his way rejoicing.

ACTS 8:26-39 · IN SHORT

An angel sent Philip to the desert road to Gaza. There he met an Ethiopian official, a man of great authority, returning from Jerusalem and reading the prophet Isaiah in his chariot. He did not understand what he read, so he asked Philip to explain it. Philip told him the good news about Jesus. When they came to water the man asked to be baptized, and after his baptism he went on his way rejoicing.

SACRIFICE He traveled a long distance to seek God.

HUMILITY Although he was important, he was willing to learn from others.

OBEDIENCE When he understood the truth, he responded immediately.

He rejoiced after his baptism because he now had a real relationship with God.

REFLECT — Are you seeking God like this?

SCRIPTURE

ASK, SEEK, KNOCK

MATTHEW 7:7-8 · NIV

⁷ “Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you. ⁸ For everyone who asks receives; the one who seeks finds; and to the one who knocks, the door will be opened.

The promise is not made to the curious. It is made to the one who asks, seeks, and knocks — three verbs, all of them active.

What is one thing you will ask God for this week, and one thing you will go looking for in His Word?

READ MATTHEW 7:7-8

REFLECT

ANSWER HONESTLY

What am I truly seeking in life?

What takes most of my time, attention, and energy?

Do I only seek God when I have problems?

Am I willing to seek God with all my heart?

CHALLENGE

- Pray and talk to God daily
- Read the Bible every day (start with the Gospel of John)
- Make time for God, not just when convenient
- Continue this study and take the next step

PRAYER

God,

I want to seek You with all my heart. Help me to desire You more than anything else.

Teach me to trust You, follow You, and live according to Your Word. Guide me as I begin this journey to know You more.

Amen.

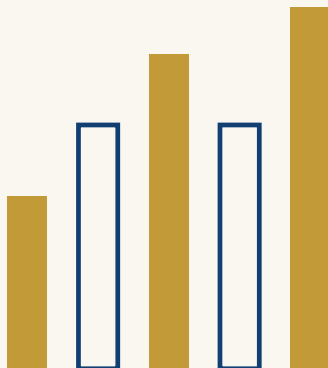
DATE OF THIS STUDY**STUDIED WITH**

WORD OF GOD

Making the Bible Your Standard for Life

PURPOSE

To decide to make the Bible your standard for life.



PURPOSE

To help you decide to make the Bible your standard for life and to build conviction about what the Bible says about itself.

MAIN QUESTION

What is your standard in life?

Do you believe the Bible is the Word of God?

Do you trust it enough to follow it?

INTRO

Every person lives by a standard. Some follow:

- personal opinion
- culture
- emotions
- traditions

But the question is: **What determines what is right and wrong in your life?**

If the Bible is truly the Word of God, then it must become our final authority.

YOUR ANSWER**BEFORE WE OPEN THE BIBLE****ILLUSTRATION**

If you wanted to measure something accurately, you would need a standard like a ruler. Without a standard, everything becomes a guess.



What is the standard of measurement in your life?

Write down what has actually decided right and wrong for you until now.

BACKGROUND**FACTS ABOUT THE BIBLE**

- 01** Written by around 40 authors
- 02** Written in three languages: Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek
- 03** Written across three continents: Asia, Africa, and Europe
- 04** Written over a period of about 1,500 years
- 05** Contains hundreds of prophecies fulfilled in Jesus
- 06** No proven contradiction despite its complexity
- 07** More ancient copies than any other historical document

LEADER'S NOTE

These facts do not prove the Bible is from God, and they are not offered as proof. They answer a different objection — that the Bible is an ordinary book, casually assembled. Keep the weight on what Scripture claims about itself, which is the next page.

SCRIPTURE

ALL SCRIPTURE IS GOD-BREATHED

2 TIMOTHY 3:16–17 • NIV

¹⁶ All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness, ¹⁷ so that the servant of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work.

Do you believe that all Scripture is from God?

READ 2 TIMOTHY 3:16–17

UNDERSTAND

The Bible is useful to teach, correct, rebuke, and train — so that a person may be fully equipped. It is not just for information. It is meant to transform your life.

To accept the Bible as God's Word means:

- allowing it to correct you
- allowing it to change your thinking
- allowing it to guide your decisions

SCRIPTURE

ALIVE AND ACTIVE

HEBREWS 4:12-13 · NIV

¹² For the word of God is alive and active. Sharper than any double-edged sword, it penetrates even to dividing soul and spirit, joints and marrow; it judges the thoughts and attitudes of the heart. ¹³ Nothing in all creation is hidden from God's sight. Everything is uncovered and laid bare before the eyes of him to whom we must give account.

UNDERSTAND

The Word of God is living and active. It exposes the human heart. The Bible is like a mirror. It reveals:

- motives
- intentions
- hidden attitudes

Sometimes it is uncomfortable, but it is necessary for growth.

TRUTH

The goal is not just to read the Bible, but to let the Bible change you.

WARNING**THREE THINGS THAT TAKE AWAY FROM GOD'S WORD****1 · INTERPRETATION****2 PETER 1:19–21**

The Bible is meant to be understood as God intended, not adjusted to fit our opinions.

2 · EMOTIONS**JOHN 8:31–32**

Feelings do not determine truth. You can feel right and still be wrong. Truth comes from God's Word.

Which of the two has had more influence on what you believe — your own reading, or how you felt at the time?

WARNING**THREE THINGS THAT TAKE AWAY FROM GOD'S WORD****3 · TRADITIONS****MARK 7:1–13**

Religious or cultural traditions can override God's Word.

EXAMPLE

Following tradition instead of obeying Scripture.

WARNING

If we are not careful, we may follow what is familiar instead of what is true.

LEADER'S NOTE

This is the page where people get quiet. Most of us inherited our beliefs before we ever examined them. Do not press for a confession here — let Lesson 5 do that work, where a specific tradition is named and tested against Scripture.

SCRIPTURE

LIFE AND DOCTRINE

1 TIMOTHY 4:16 · NIV

¹⁶ Watch your life and doctrine closely. Persevere in them, because if you do, you will save both yourself and your hearers.

What is more important: life or doctrine?

READ 1 TIMOTHY 4:16

Both are equally important. You must guard what you believe (doctrine) and how you live (life). Wrong beliefs lead to wrong actions.

ACTS 17:10–11 · NIV

¹⁰ As soon as it was night, the believers sent Paul and Silas away to Berea. On arriving there, they went to the Jewish synagogue. ¹¹ Now the Berean Jews were of more noble character than those in Thessalonica, for they received the message with great eagerness and examined the Scriptures every day to see if what Paul said was true.

IN SHORT

The believers in Berea received Paul's message with great eagerness, and examined the Scriptures every day to see whether what he said was true.

APPLICATION

Do not rely only on what others say. Study the Bible for yourself.

SCRIPTURE

DO WHAT IT SAYS

JAMES 1:22–25 · NIV

²² Do not merely listen to the word, and so deceive yourselves. Do what it says. ²³ Anyone who listens to the word but does not do what it says is like someone who looks at his face in a mirror ²⁴ and, after looking at himself, goes away and immediately forgets what he looks like. ²⁵ But whoever looks intently into the perfect law that gives freedom, and continues in it—not forgetting what they have heard, but doing it—they will be blessed in what they do.

UNDERSTAND

Listening without applying leads to self-deception. The Word of God reveals our character. It is not enough to hear, read, or agree. You must obey.

Are you willing to apply what the Bible teaches in your life?

SCRIPTURE

THE WORD THAT JUDGES

JOHN 12:48 • NIV

⁴⁸ There is a judge for the one who rejects me and does not accept my words; the very words I have spoken will condemn them at the last day.

UNDERSTAND

Jesus says His Word will judge us. The Bible is God's standard — not one standard among several, and not a standard we are free to revise.

KEY TRUTH

You will not be measured against your own reading of Scripture. You will be measured against Scripture.

From today, what will be your standard?

READ JOHN 12:48

REFLECT

ANSWER HONESTLY

What has been my standard in life?

Do I follow God’s Word or my own opinions?

Am I willing to let the Bible correct me?

What is one thing I have believed that I have never checked in Scripture?

CHALLENGE

- Read the Bible daily
- Begin with the Gospel of John
- Apply what you learn
- Make God's Word your standard

PRAYER

God,

Help me to trust Your Word completely.

Teach me to follow Your truth, not my own understanding.

Give me a heart that is willing to obey and be changed.

Amen.

DATE OF THIS STUDY**STUDIED WITH**

DISCIPLESHIP

Following Jesus with Commitment
and Obedience

PURPOSE

To understand what it means to be a
disciple of Jesus.



PURPOSE

To understand what it means to be a disciple of Jesus and how that applies to your life.

MAIN QUESTION

What is a disciple? Why does Jesus call people to follow Him? What does it cost to follow Him? How should a disciple live?

INTRO

Jesus did not only call people to believe in Him. He called them to follow Him.

Discipleship is not just learning information about Jesus. It is a life of surrender, obedience, love, and growth.

But the question is: **Are you only listening to Jesus, or are you truly following Him?**

YOUR ANSWER**BEFORE WE OPEN THE BIBLE**

What has following Jesus cost you so far?

Write it plainly. If the honest answer is nothing yet, write that.

What is the one thing you would find hardest to give up if He asked?

LEADER'S NOTE

Keep this page. The second answer is usually the real subject of the lesson, and it will come back on the Luke 14 page when Jesus talks about counting the cost.

SCRIPTURE

THE COMMAND

MATTHEW 28:18-20 · NIV

¹⁸ Then Jesus came to them and said, “All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me. ¹⁹ Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, ²⁰ and teaching them to obey everything I have commanded you. And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age.”

What did Jesus command His followers to do?

READ MATTHEW 28:18-20

UNDERSTAND

- Discipleship is not optional. It is the mission Jesus gave to His people.
- Making disciples includes baptizing them and teaching them to obey.

SCRIPTURE

CALLED CHRISTIANS FIRST AT ANTIOCH

ACTS 11:25-26 • NIV

²⁵ Then Barnabas went to Tarsus to look for Saul, ²⁶ and when he found him, he brought him to Antioch. So for a whole year Barnabas and Saul met with the church and taught great numbers of people. The disciples were called Christians first at Antioch.

DEFINITION

A disciple is a follower of Jesus who learns from Him, obeys Him, and helps others follow Him too.

UNDERSTAND

A disciple does not only receive truth. A disciple also grows, obeys, and helps others grow. Notice how long it took at Antioch: a whole year of meeting and teaching. Discipleship is measured in seasons, not in single decisions.

SCRIPTURE

JESUS CALLS HIS FIRST DISCIPLES

MARK 1:16–18 • NIV

¹⁶ As Jesus walked beside the Sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and his brother Andrew casting a net into the lake, for they were fishermen. ¹⁷ “Come, follow me,” Jesus said, “and I will send you out to fish for people.” ¹⁸ At once they left their nets and followed him.

How did the first disciples respond to Jesus?

READ MARK 1:16–18

UNDERSTAND

Jesus called ordinary people to follow Him. Their response was immediate. They left what defined their old life and followed Him. To follow Jesus means responding to His call, trusting His direction, and allowing Him to change your purpose.

A disciple is not self-made. Jesus says, “I will make you.”

SCRIPTURE

DENY YOURSELF, TAKE UP YOUR CROSS

LUKE 9:23-26 • NIV

²³ Then he said to them all: “Whoever wants to be my disciple must deny themselves and take up their cross daily and follow me. ²⁴ For whoever wants to save their life will lose it, but whoever loses their life for me will save it. ²⁵ What good is it for someone to gain the whole world, and yet lose or forfeit their very self? ²⁶ Whoever is ashamed of me and my words, the Son of Man will be ashamed of them when he comes in his glory and in the glory of the Father and of the holy angels.

TO DENY YOURSELF

- not putting yourself first
- not living by your own will
- not making life all about you

TO TAKE UP YOUR CROSS

- dying to sin
- choosing obedience
- following Jesus even when it is costly

A disciple does not follow Jesus only when convenient. A disciple follows Him daily.

SCRIPTURE

COUNTING THE COST

LUKE 14:25–33 • NIV

²⁵ Large crowds were traveling with Jesus, and turning to them he said: ²⁶ “If anyone comes to me and does not hate father and mother, wife and children, brothers and sisters—yes, even their own life—such a person cannot be my disciple. ²⁷ And whoever does not carry their cross and follow me cannot be my disciple.

²⁸ “Suppose one of you wants to build a tower. Won’t you first sit down and estimate the cost to see if you have enough money to complete it? ²⁹ For if you lay the foundation and are not able to finish it, everyone who sees it will ridicule you, ³⁰ saying, ‘This person began to build and wasn’t able to finish.’

³¹ “Or suppose a king is about to go to war against another king. Won’t he first sit down and consider whether he is able with ten thousand men to oppose the one coming against him with twenty thousand? ³² If he is not able, he will send a delegation while the other is still a long way off and will ask for terms of peace. ³³ In the same way, those of you who do not give up everything you have cannot be my disciples.

LUKE 14:25-33 · IN SHORT

²⁵⁻²⁷ Jesus said anyone who does not put Him first and carry their cross cannot be His disciple. ²⁸⁻³⁰ He spoke of counting the cost like a builder planning a tower. ³¹⁻³² He compared it to a king preparing for battle. ³³ He said anyone who does not give up everything cannot be His disciple.

Why is it important to count the cost of discipleship?

READ LUKE 14:25-33

Jesus never hid the cost of following Him. To count the cost means understanding that Jesus must come first, accepting that following Him will require sacrifice, and choosing Him above comfort, pride, and control.

KEY TRUTH

A disciple does not add Jesus to life. A disciple gives life to Jesus.

SCRIPTURE

TEACH US TO PRAY

LUKE 11:1-4 · NIV

¹ One day Jesus was praying in a certain place. When he finished, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as John taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say:

“Father,
hallowed be your name,
your kingdom come.

³ Give us each day our daily bread.

⁴ Forgive us our sins,
for we also forgive everyone who sins against us.
And lead us not into temptation.”

LUKE 11:1-4 · IN SHORT

¹ The disciples asked Jesus to teach them to pray. ²⁻⁴ Jesus taught them to pray with reverence, dependence on God, forgiveness, and surrender to His will.

UNDERSTAND

A disciple grows in relationship with God. Notice what the disciples asked for. They did not ask for a method of ministry. They asked to be taught to pray.

What does your prayer life look like in an ordinary week — not at its best?

READ LUKE 11:1-4

SCRIPTURE

THE GREATEST COMMANDMENT

MATTHEW 22:34–40 • NIV

³⁴ Hearing that Jesus had silenced the Sadducees, the Pharisees got together. ³⁵ One of them, an expert in the law, tested him with this question: ³⁶ “Teacher, which is the greatest commandment in the Law?”

³⁷ Jesus replied: “Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind.’ ³⁸ This is the first and greatest commandment. ³⁹ And the second is like it: ‘Love your neighbor as yourself.’ ⁴⁰ All the Law and the Prophets hang on these two commandments.”

IN SHORT

^{34–36} Jesus was asked about the greatest commandment. ³⁷ He said to love the Lord your God with all your heart, soul, and mind. ³⁸ This is the first and greatest commandment. ³⁹ The second is to love your neighbor as yourself. ⁴⁰ All the Law and the Prophets hang on these two commandments.

How should a disciple live?

READ MATTHEW 22:34–40

UNDERSTAND

A disciple learns to pray, to love God fully, to love others sincerely, and to live under God’s will. Discipleship is not only about activity. It is about a life centered on God and shaped by love.

SCRIPTURE

THE MARK OF A DISCIPLE

JOHN 13:34–35 • NIV

³⁴ “A new command I give you: Love one another. As I have loved you, so you must love one another. ³⁵ By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you love one another.”

What identifies a true disciple of Jesus?

READ JOHN 13:34–35

UNDERSTAND

The true mark of a disciple is love — not just knowledge, not just words, not just church activity. Love shows humility, forgiveness, patience, service, and commitment to others.

People should be able to see Jesus in the way His disciples love.

REFLECT

ANSWER HONESTLY

Am I truly following Jesus, or only agreeing with Him?

What am I still unwilling to surrender?

Have I counted the cost of discipleship?

Am I growing in prayer, obedience, and love?

Do others see the love of Christ in my life?

CHALLENGE

- Read these passages again slowly.
- Ask God what needs to change in your life.
- Choose one area where you need to obey Jesus more fully.
- Follow Him daily, not only when it is easy.

PRAYER

Lord Jesus,

Thank You for calling me to follow You.

Teach me to deny myself, obey You daily, and love others the way You love. Shape my life so that I may truly live as Your disciple.

Amen.

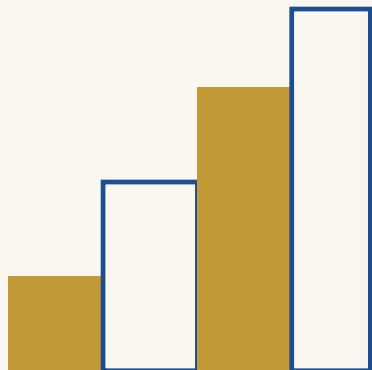
DATE OF THIS STUDY**STUDIED WITH**

KINGDOM OF GOD

Knowing God's Rule, God's People, and
God's Purpose

PURPOSE

To discover what the Kingdom of God is
and how a person enters it.



PURPOSE

To discover what the Kingdom of God is and what it means to enter and live in it.

MAIN QUESTION

What is the Kingdom of God? Who is the King? Who belongs to His Kingdom? How does a person enter it? What kind of life is found in it?

INTRO

Many people think of a kingdom as a place, a territory, or a government. But when the Bible speaks about the Kingdom of God, it points us to something greater. It is about God's rule, God's reign, and God's authority over every life that submits to Him.

This lesson will help you understand that the Kingdom of God is not just a future hope. It is also a present reality for those who believe in Jesus, are born again, and live under His rule.

But the question is: **Who is ruling your life right now?**

YOUR ANSWER**BEFORE WE OPEN THE BIBLE**

Who is ruling your life right now?

List what actually decides your week — the people, habits, pressures, and ambitions that get the final say.

Where in that list does God appear?

LEADER'S NOTE

Everyone answers “God” to the first question if you ask it directly, so ask the second question and let the list answer for them.

SCRIPTURE

REPENT, THE KINGDOM HAS COME NEAR

MATTHEW 3:1-2 · NIV

JOHN THE BAPTIST PREPARES THE WAY

¹ In those days John the Baptist came, preaching in the wilderness of Judea ² and saying, “Repent, for the kingdom of heaven has come near.”

MATTHEW 4:17 · NIV

¹⁷ From that time on Jesus began to preach, “Repent, for the kingdom of heaven has come near.”

UNDERSTAND

The message of both John and Jesus began with the same call: repent. To repent means:

- turn away from sin
- change your mind and direction
- return to God

The Kingdom is not something we enter casually. When God’s rule comes near, we are called to respond.

SCRIPTURE

ALREADY, AND NOT ONLY LATER

MARK 9:1 · NIV

¹ And he said to them, “Truly I tell you, some who are standing here will not taste death before they see that the kingdom of God has come with power.”

MARK 9:1 · IN SHORT

Jesus said that some standing there would not taste death before they saw the kingdom of God come with power.

LUKE 17:20-21 · NIV

²⁰ Once, on being asked by the Pharisees when the kingdom of God would come, Jesus replied, “The coming of the kingdom of God is not something that can be observed, ²¹ nor will people say, ‘Here it is,’ or ‘There it is,’ because the kingdom of God is in your midst.”

IN SHORT

Jesus said the kingdom of God is not something observed outwardly, because the kingdom of God is in your midst.

Is the Kingdom of God only something future?

READ LUKE 17:20-21**UNDERSTAND**

It is also a present reality. Where Jesus is received as King, where His truth is believed, and where His will is obeyed, His Kingdom is present.

The Kingdom is not mainly about location. It is about God’s rule.

SCRIPTURE

BORN OF WATER AND SPIRIT

JOHN 3:1-7 • NIV

JESUS TEACHES NICODEMUS

¹ Now there was a Pharisee, a man named Nicodemus who was a member of the Jewish ruling council. ² He came to Jesus at night and said, “Rabbi, we know that you are a teacher who has come from God. For no one could perform the signs you are doing if God were not with him.” ³ Jesus replied, “Very truly I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless they are born again.” ⁴ “How can someone be born when they are old?” Nicodemus asked. “Surely they cannot enter a second time into their mother’s womb to be born!” ⁵ Jesus answered, “Very truly I tell you, no one can enter the kingdom of God unless they are born of water and the Spirit. ⁶ Flesh gives birth to flesh, but the Spirit gives birth to spirit. ⁷ You should not be surprised at my saying, ‘You must be born again.’”

UNDERSTAND

A person does not enter God’s Kingdom by religion, good works, or human effort. Jesus said a person must be born again — of water and the Spirit.

This is the same passage Lesson 5 returns to, where what Jesus means by water and Spirit is set out in full.

SCRIPTURE

WHO DO YOU SAY I AM?

MATTHEW 16:13-19 · NIV

¹³ When Jesus came to the region of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his disciples, “Who do people say the Son of Man is?”

¹⁴ They replied, “Some say John the Baptist; others say Elijah; and still others, Jeremiah or one of the prophets.”

¹⁵ “But what about you?” he asked. “Who do you say I am?”

¹⁶ Simon Peter answered, “You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.”

¹⁷ Jesus replied, “Blessed are you, Simon son of Jonah, for this was not revealed to you by flesh and blood, but by my Father in heaven. ¹⁸ And I tell you that you are Peter, and on this rock I will build my church, and the gates of Hades will not overcome it. ¹⁹ I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven; whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.”

MATTHEW 16:13-19 · IN SHORT

¹³⁻¹⁵ Jesus asked His disciples who people said He was. They gave different answers. Jesus asked them, “Who do you say I am?” ¹⁶ Peter answered, “You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.” ¹⁷ Jesus said this was revealed by the Father. ¹⁸ He said He would build His church. ¹⁹ He spoke of the keys of the kingdom of heaven and His authority.

Who is the King of the Kingdom of God?

READ MATTHEW 16:13-19

UNDERSTAND

The Kingdom of God is centered on Jesus. He is not only a teacher, a prophet, or a good example. He is the Messiah, the Son of the living God, the rightful King.

To belong to the Kingdom is to submit to Him.

SCRIPTURE

WAGES, AND A GIFT

ROMANS 6:23 • NIV

²³ For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.

UNDERSTAND

Sin brings death, but God offers life through Jesus Christ. One is earned and one is given. Nobody works their way into the Kingdom, and nobody is admitted without responding to the King.

KEY TRUTH

The Kingdom of God is entered through faith in Christ, not through self-effort.

Which have you been trying to earn, and which have you received?

READ ROMANS 6:23

SCRIPTURE

THE DAY OF PENTECOST

ACTS 2:1-4 · NIV

¹ When the day of Pentecost came, they were all together in one place. ² Suddenly a sound like the blowing of a violent wind came from heaven and filled the whole house where they were sitting. ³ They saw what seemed to be tongues of fire that separated and came to rest on each of them. ⁴ All of them were filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues as the Spirit enabled them.

IN SHORT

¹ When the day of Pentecost came, the believers were together. ² A sound like a violent wind came from heaven. ³ Tongues like fire rested on them. ⁴ All of them were filled with the Holy Spirit.

UNDERSTAND

The Kingdom came with power, exactly as Jesus said it would. What happens next in Acts 2 is not a private experience — Peter stands up and preaches, and the crowd is asked to respond.

What did the Holy Spirit come to do, according to this chapter?

READ ACTS 2:1-4

SCRIPTURE

THE RESPONSE OF THE CROWD

ACTS 2:36-41 · NIV

³⁶ “Therefore let all Israel be assured of this: God has made this Jesus, whom you crucified, both Lord and Messiah.”

³⁷ When the people heard this, they were cut to the heart and said to Peter and the other apostles, “Brothers, what shall we do?”

³⁸ Peter replied, “Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. And you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. ³⁹ The promise is for you and your children and for all who are far off—for all whom the Lord our God will call.”

⁴⁰ With many other words he warned them; and he pleaded with them, “Save yourselves from this corrupt generation.” ⁴¹ Those who accepted his message were baptized, and about three thousand were added to their number that day.

ACTS 2:36-41 · IN SHORT

³⁶ Peter declared that Jesus is Lord and Christ. ³⁷⁻⁴¹ The people responded with conviction, repentance, baptism, and were added to the believers.

ACTS 2:38 · NIV

³⁸ Peter replied, “Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. And you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.

How do people respond when Jesus is preached as Lord and Christ?

READ ACTS 2:36-41**UNDERSTAND**

- When the people understood who Jesus was, they responded with conviction, repentance, baptism, and obedience.
- Lesson 5 takes this passage verse by verse. Do not settle it here — read it, and carry the question forward.

SCRIPTURE

THE LIFE FOUND IN THE KINGDOM

LUKE 23:50-52 • NIV

THE BURIAL OF JESUS

⁵⁰ Now there was a man named Joseph, a member of the Council, a good and upright man, ⁵¹ who had not consented to their decision and action. He came from the Judean town of Arimathea, and he himself was waiting for the kingdom of God. ⁵² Going to Pilate, he asked for Jesus' body.

1 JOHN 1:3-4 • NIV

³ We proclaim to you what we have seen and heard, so that you also may have fellowship with us. And our fellowship is with the Father and with his Son, Jesus Christ. ⁴ We write this to make our joy complete.

IN SHORT

³ What the apostles had seen and heard, they proclaimed so others may have fellowship with them. Their fellowship is with the Father and with His Son, Jesus Christ. ⁴ They wrote these things so that their joy may be complete.

UNDERSTAND

The Kingdom of God is not only personal. It is shared with God's people, who live with hope, fellowship, joy, and faithfulness. Joseph waited for the Kingdom. The believers lived in fellowship with God and with one another.

REFLECT

ANSWER HONESTLY

Who is ruling my life right now?

Have I truly repented and submitted to Jesus as King?

Am I trying to enter God’s Kingdom by my own effort, or by faith in Christ?

Am I living under God’s rule in my daily life?

Am I growing in fellowship with God and His people?

CHALLENGE

- Read these passages again slowly.
- Ask God to show you where you still resist His rule.
- Submit every area of your life to Jesus.
- Live as someone who belongs to His Kingdom.

PRAYER

God,

Thank You for calling people into Your Kingdom.

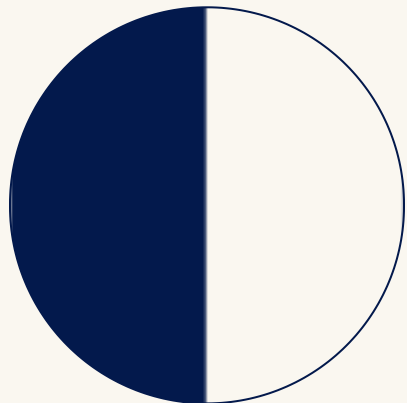
Teach me to repent, believe, and live under the rule of Jesus. Change my heart and help me walk as part of Your people.

Amen.

DATE OF THIS STUDY**STUDIED WITH**

LIGHT AND DARKNESS

Understanding the plan of salvation, and where you stand in it.



PURPOSE

To understand the Plan of Salvation.

PURPOSE

To understand the Plan of Salvation — what separates a person from God, what God has done about it, and how a person responds.

MAIN QUESTION

Where are you right now — in the darkness, or in the light?

HOW THIS LESSON RUNS

- 01** You draw your own spiritual timeline before any teaching begins.
- 02** Scripture sets out the problem of sin and God's answer to it.
- 03** You come back to that timeline at the end and compare it with what Scripture says.

YOUR TIMELINE**BEFORE WE OPEN THE BIBLE**

What are your spiritual highlights?

Mark the moments that mattered — when you first heard about God, when you started asking questions, when something changed. Write the event above the line and roughly when it happened below it.

A horizontal timeline consisting of a solid dark blue line with four white circles spaced evenly along it. Above and below the line are dashed dark blue lines, creating a space for writing.

LEADER'S NOTE

If they hesitate, draw the timeline for them on scratch paper first and fill in two moments from your own life. Do not correct anything they write here — the whole lesson depends on this being their honest account, so that the comparison at the end is theirs to make.

ASK

THREE QUESTIONS

When do you believe you were saved?

When did you receive the Holy Spirit?

When did you receive the forgiveness of sin?

SCRIPTURE

TWO PEOPLES, TWO CONDITIONS

1 PETER 2:9-10 · NIV

⁹ But you are a chosen people, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, God's special possession, that you may declare the praises of him who called you out of darkness into his wonderful light. ¹⁰ Once you were not a people, but now you are the people of God; once you had not received mercy, but now you have received mercy.

DARKNESS	LIGHT
Not a People of God	People of God
No Mercy	Mercy
Lost	Saved
Not a Christian	Christian
Not a Disciple	Disciple

UNDERSTAND

Every person is either in the darkness or the light. Peter gives no third category. The list on the previous page is not a scale from worse to better — it is one column or the other, and every line in a column moves together.

KEY TRUTH

There is no twilight zone. Where are you?

Looking at the two columns — which one describes you today, and what makes you say so?

READ 1 PETER 2:9–10**LEADER'S NOTE**

Most people place themselves somewhere in the middle. Let the answer stand and move on — the rest of the lesson answers it far better than an argument here would.

SCRIPTURE

THE PROBLEM, AND ITS PRICE

ROMANS 3:23 · NIV

²³ for all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God,

ROMANS 6:23 · NIV

²³ For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.

If all have sinned, what does that mean for you?

READ ROMANS 3:23; 6:23

UNDERSTAND

- For all have sinned, hence all people are condemned and in need of a savior.
- The penalty for sin is spiritual death, hence our spirit needs to be born again.

SCRIPTURE

BORN OF WATER AND SPIRIT

JOHN 3:1-7 · NIV

¹ Now there was a Pharisee, a man named Nicodemus who was a member of the Jewish ruling council. ² He came to Jesus at night and said, “Rabbi, we know that you are a teacher who has come from God. For no one could perform the signs you are doing if God were not with him.” ³ Jesus replied, “Very truly I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless they are born again.” ⁴ “How can someone be born when they are old?” Nicodemus asked. “Surely they cannot enter a second time into their mother's womb to be born!” ⁵ Jesus answered, “Very truly I tell you, no one can enter the kingdom of God unless they are born of water and the Spirit. ⁶ Flesh gives birth to flesh, but the Spirit gives birth to spirit. ⁷ You should not be surprised at my saying, ‘You must be born again.’”

UNDERSTAND

- We must be born again of water and the spirit.
- This is a personal decision as an adult.

SCRIPTURE

THE MESSAGE TO BELIEVE

ACTS 2:22-24 · NIV

²² “Fellow Israelites, listen to this: Jesus of Nazareth was a man accredited by God to you by miracles, wonders and signs, which God did among you through him, as you yourselves know. ²³ This man was handed over to you by God's deliberate plan and foreknowledge; and you, with the help of wicked men, put him to death by nailing him to the cross. ²⁴ But God raised him from the dead, freeing him from the agony of death, because it was impossible for death to keep its hold on him.”

What message must one believe to be saved?

READ ACTS 2:22-24

LEADER'S NOTE

Three things, and the verse numbers are the proof. That Jesus is from God (v. 22). That Jesus was physically raised from the dead (v. 24). And that everyone is responsible for the crucifixion of Christ (v. 23) — because all have sinned.

SCRIPTURE

CUT TO THE HEART

ACTS 2:37 • NIV

³⁷ When the people heard this, they were cut to the heart and said to Peter and the other apostles, “Brothers, what shall we do?”

What does it mean to be “cut to the heart”?

READ ACTS 2:37

LEADER'S NOTE

Definition: deep emotional sorrow. The people recognized their responsibility for the death of Jesus, and their response reflected godly sorrow — “What should we do?”

SCRIPTURE

WHAT DID THEY DO?

ACTS 2:38–42 • NIV

³⁸ Peter replied, “Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. And you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. ³⁹ The promise is for you and your children and for all who are far off—for all whom the Lord our God will call.” ⁴⁰ With many other words he warned them; and he pleaded with them, “Save yourselves from this corrupt generation.” ⁴¹ Those who accepted his message were baptized, and about three thousand were added to their number that day. ⁴² They devoted themselves to the apostles’ teaching and to fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer.

Once the people believed, what did they do?

READ ACTS 2:38–42

UNDERSTAND

- Repent (turn to God).
- Be baptized (be immersed in water).
- **Their sins were forgiven. This is the point in time when a person is saved.**
- **The Holy Spirit is given to those who are baptized.**

SCRIPTURE

MORE THAN A SYMBOL

ROMANS 6:3–8 • NIV

³ Or don't you know that all of us who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death? ⁴ We were therefore buried with him through baptism into death in order that, just as Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, we too may live a new life. ⁵ For if we have been united with him in a death like his, we will certainly also be united with him in a resurrection like his. ⁶ For we know that our old self was crucified with him so that the body ruled by sin might be done away with, that we should no longer be slaves to sin— ⁷ because anyone who has died has been set free from sin. ⁸ Now if we died with Christ, we believe that we will also live with him.

UNDERSTAND

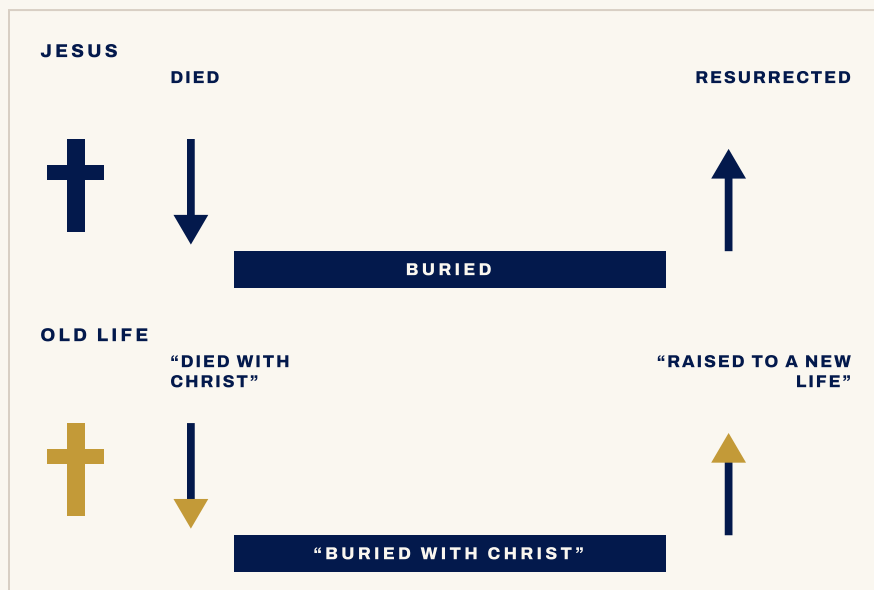
- Baptism is the participation in the death, burial, and resurrection of Christ — **it is more than just a symbol.**
- This is the point in time when we are freed from sin and united with Christ. The wall of sin is broken down — we are forgiven of our sins!

KEY TRUTH

Baptism is not a picture of something that already happened. It is where it happens.

UNDERSTAND

TWO TRACKS, ONE PATTERN



What happened to Jesus in history happens to a person at baptism. The pattern is the same and the order is the same: death, burial, resurrection.

Explain the diagram in your own words.

READ ROMANS 6:3-8

UNDERSTAND

WHAT CROSSES THE LINE

DARKNESS	LIGHT
Sin Separates from God	ACTS 2:38 Sin is Forgiven
Born Again Of Water and Spirit JOHN 3:5	ACTS 2:38 Water = Baptism Spirit = Received at Baptism
ROMANS 3:25 Faith in the Blood of Jesus Saves Us	Jesus shed his blood when he died. In baptism we share by faith in the death, burial and resurrection of Jesus. Thus our sins are covered through the blood of Jesus and we are forgiven and SAVED!

In your own words: what does the water do, and what does faith do?

SCRIPTURE

WHAT ACTIVATES IT

COLOSSIANS 2:11–12 · NIV

¹¹ In him you were also circumcised with a circumcision not performed by human hands. Your whole self ruled by the flesh was put off when you were circumcised by Christ, ¹² having been buried with him in baptism, in which you were also raised with him through your faith in the working of God, who raised him from the dead.

What activates the power of God at baptism?

READ COLOSSIANS 2:11–12

KEY TRUTH

It is our faith. We are saved by faith at the moment of baptism — not by the water itself.

SCRIPTURE

TRADITION AGAINST TRUTH

MATTHEW 15:6-9 · NIV

⁶ they are not to ‘honor their father or mother’ with it. Thus you nullify the word of God for the sake of your tradition. ⁷ You hypocrites! Isaiah was right when he prophesied about you: ⁸ “‘These people honor me with their lips, but their hearts are far from me. ⁹ They worship me in vain; their teachings are merely human rules.’”

UNDERSTAND

False doctrines often arise from religious tradition. Two of them touch directly on what this lesson has just established.

1 · INFANT BAPTISM

Refuted by Ezekiel 18:20 — guilt is not inherited; and Luke 18:16–17 — children already belong to the kingdom.

BEGAN	BECAME CHURCH DOCTRINE
approximately 2nd century AD	549 AD

Which of the things you believe came from Scripture, and which came from tradition?

READ MATTHEW 15:6-9

2 · PRAYING JESUS INTO YOUR HEART

A misinterpretation of Revelation 3:20. That passage was addressed to baptized disciples — a church being called back, not unbelievers being invited in.

ORIGINATED

early 1800s America

REVELATION 3:20 · NIV

²⁰ Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in and eat with that person, and they with me.

Who is Jesus speaking to in Revelation 3? Read verses 14 and 19 before you answer.

READ REVELATION 3:14–22

LEADER'S NOTE

Many people have prayed this prayer sincerely, and hearing it questioned can feel like an accusation. Be gentle. The point is not that their sincerity was fake, but that Scripture names a different response — and it is still open to them.

SCRIPTURE

THIS WATER NOW SAVES YOU

1 PETER 3:18–22 · NIV

¹⁸ For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, to bring you to God. He was put to death in the body but made alive in the Spirit. ¹⁹ After being made alive, he went and made proclamation to the imprisoned spirits— ²⁰ to those who were disobedient long ago when God waited patiently in the days of Noah while the ark was being built. In it only a few people, eight in all, were saved through water, ²¹ and this water symbolizes baptism that now saves you also—not the removal of dirt from the body but the pledge of a clear conscience toward God. It saves you by the resurrection of Jesus Christ, ²² who has gone into heaven and is at God's right hand—with angels, authorities and powers in submission to him.

UNDERSTAND

- What does the water represent in this passage? Noah's flood.
- In the same way the flood washed away the sinful people in Noah's time, baptism cleanses us of sin through Christ.
- Baptism “now saves you” — this confirms again that baptism is **not merely symbolic**, but the moment our sins are forgiven by faith.

KEY TRUTH

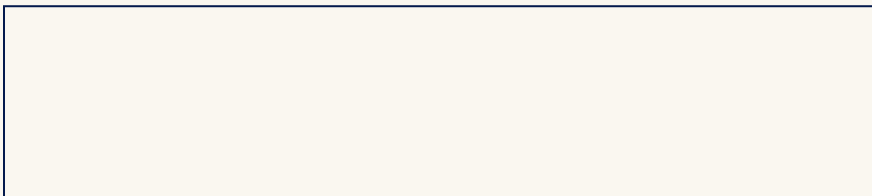
REVIEW YOUR TIMELINE

Does it align with the Biblical process of salvation? If not, now is the time to repent and be baptized.

Turn back to the timeline you drew at the start of this lesson, before any of this was opened. Put a mark where Scripture says forgiveness, the Holy Spirit, and salvation are given. Compare the two.

Where do your timeline and the Bible's account agree, and where do they not?

READ ACTS 2:38



LEADER'S NOTE

This is the point of the lesson. Do not rush it and do not answer for them. If they want to be baptized, arrange it now rather than later — Acts 2 gives no waiting period.

ASK

REFLECT AND RESPOND

Having read all of this — are you in the darkness or in the light? Write your answer, and the reason for it.

CHALLENGE

Respond urgently: be baptized for the forgiveness of your sins so you can be united with Jesus!

DATE OF THIS STUDY

STUDIED WITH

PRAYER

Father,

You called people out of darkness into your wonderful light, and you did not leave the way into it unclear.

Give me an honest heart about where I actually stand. Where I have trusted something you never promised, show me. Where I have delayed, give me urgency.

Thank you for the death, burial and resurrection of Jesus, and for making a way for me to share in it.

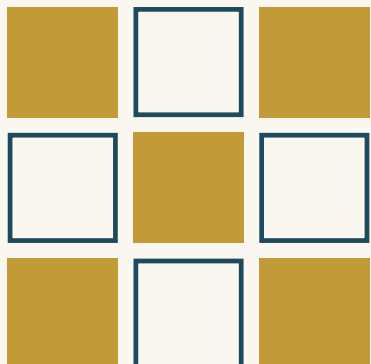
Amen.

CHURCH

Understanding God's Heart for His Church

PURPOSE

To understand how God values His Church and how we must function in it.



PURPOSE

To gain a deeper understanding of how God values His Church and His wonderful plans for her, and to know how we must function as part of God's household.

MAIN QUESTION

When you hear the word Church, what comes into your mind?

INTRO

Many people think of church as a building, a service, or a religious gathering. But in Scripture, the Church is far more than that. The Church is God's people, Christ's body, God's family, and the bride of Christ.

To understand the Church rightly is to understand how God wants us to live, love, serve, and remain faithful to Him. This lesson will help us see the beauty, value, and calling of the Church.

But the question is: **How do you truly view the Church?**

YOUR ANSWER

BEFORE WE OPEN THE BIBLE

When you hear the word Church, what comes into your mind?

Write the first three things — not the correct answer, the honest one.

What has your experience of church been so far?

LEADER'S NOTE

Some will write about a building, some about a bad experience. Both are useful. Do not correct either one now; the lesson replaces the picture rather than arguing with it.

SCRIPTURE

JESUS IS THE HEAD

COLOSSIANS 1:15–18 · NIV

¹⁵ The Son is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation.

¹⁶ For in him all things were created: things in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or powers or rulers or authorities; all things have been created through him and for him. ¹⁷ He is before all things, and in him all things hold together. ¹⁸ And he is the head of the body, the church; he is the beginning and the firstborn from among the dead, so that in everything he might have the supremacy.

IN SHORT

Jesus is the exact representation of God the Father. All things were created through Him and for Him. He has authority over all creation and is supreme over all powers, rulers, and authorities. Jesus is also the Head of the Body, the Church.

What does it mean that Jesus is the Head and the Church is His Body?

READ COLOSSIANS 1:15–18

UNDERSTAND

The Church belongs to Jesus. He leads it, sustains it, and gives it purpose. If Jesus is the Head, then the Church must submit to Him. We do not define the Church by personal preference, culture, or convenience. We understand the Church through Christ.

SCRIPTURE

THE BODY OF CHRIST

1 CORINTHIANS 12:12–14 · NIV

¹² Just as a body, though one, has many parts, but all its many parts form one body, so it is with Christ. ¹³ For we were all baptized by one Spirit so as to form one body—whether Jews or Gentiles, slave or free—and we were all given the one Spirit to drink. ¹⁴ Even so the body is not made up of one part but of many.

IN SHORT

The Church is the Body of Christ. Just as a body is one and has many parts, and all its parts form one body, so it is with Christ. We were all baptized by one Spirit into one body, and a body is not made up of one part but of many.

UNDERSTAND

To be part of the Church means:

- belonging to Christ
- being connected to His people
- living under His authority

Are you connected to the body, or only near it?

READ 1 CORINTHIANS 12:12–14

SCRIPTURE

EVERY PART BELONGS

1 CORINTHIANS 12:15-22 · NIV

¹⁵ Now if the foot should say, “Because I am not a hand, I do not belong to the body,” it would not for that reason stop being part of the body. ¹⁶ And if the ear should say, “Because I am not an eye, I do not belong to the body,” it would not for that reason stop being part of the body. ¹⁷ If the whole body were an eye, where would the sense of hearing be? If the whole body were an ear, where would the sense of smell be? ¹⁸ But in fact God has placed the parts in the body, every one of them, just as he wanted them to be. ¹⁹ If they were all one part, where would the body be? ²⁰ As it is, there are many parts, but one body.

²¹ The eye cannot say to the hand, “I don’t need you!” And the head cannot say to the feet, “I don’t need you!” ²² On the contrary, those parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable,

1 CORINTHIANS 12:15–22 · IN SHORT

Paul explains that the body has many different parts, and each one belongs and has a purpose. God placed every part as He wanted, so no one should feel unimportant or unnecessary. At the same time, no part can say it does not need the others, because even the parts that seem weaker are still indispensable.

What does this teach us about your place in the Church?

READ 1 CORINTHIANS 12:15–22**UNDERSTAND**

God did not design the Church so that one person does everything and everyone else watches. Each believer has a place, a value, and a function. Some may be more visible, while others serve quietly. But every part matters.

SCRIPTURE

NO DIVISION IN THE BODY

1 CORINTHIANS 12:23–28 • NIV

²³ and the parts that we think are less honorable we treat with special honor. And the parts that are unpresentable are treated with special modesty, ²⁴ while our presentable parts need no special treatment. But God has put the body together, giving greater honor to the parts that lacked it, ²⁵ so that there should be no division in the body, but that its parts should have equal concern for each other. ²⁶ If one part suffers, every part suffers with it; if one part is honored, every part rejoices with it.

²⁷ Now you are the body of Christ, and each one of you is a part of it. ²⁸ And God has placed in the church first of all apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then miracles, then gifts of healing, of helping, of guidance, and of different kinds of tongues.

IN SHORT

God gave special honor even to the parts that seem less important so there would be no division in the body. Instead, every part should care for one another, suffer together, and rejoice together. Paul says believers are the body of Christ, and each person has a place and function in the church according to how God has arranged it.

UNDERSTAND

The Church becomes unhealthy when people compare, compete, or withdraw. The Church becomes strong when each member accepts their role and serves faithfully.

KEY TRUTH

Where there is pride, division grows. Where there is love, the body is strengthened.

SCRIPTURE

HOW WE TREAT ONE ANOTHER

JOHN 13:34-35 • NIV

³⁴ “A new command I give you: Love one another. As I have loved you, so you must love one another. ³⁵ By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you love one another.”

UNDERSTAND

The Church is not held together merely by attendance, activity, or structure. It is held together by love, unity, and service. To function as the Church means:

- serving one another
- caring for one another
- honoring one another
- loving one another as Christ loved us

Name one person in the church you will serve this month, and how.

SCRIPTURE

MEMBERS OF HIS HOUSEHOLD

EPHESIANS 2:19–22 · NIV

¹⁹ Consequently, you are no longer foreigners and strangers, but fellow citizens with God's people and also members of his household, ²⁰ built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Christ Jesus himself as the chief cornerstone. ²¹ In him the whole building is joined together and rises to become a holy temple in the Lord. ²² And in him you too are being built together to become a dwelling in which God lives by his Spirit.

UNDERSTAND

The Church is not only an organization. It is a family. When we come to Christ, we are no longer outsiders. This means we are not meant to live the Christian life alone. In God's family, there should be:

- belonging
- support
- growth
- accountability
- shared life in Christ

SCRIPTURE

THE BRIDE OF CHRIST

EPHESIANS 5:25-27 / REVELATION 19:6-7 · NIV

EPHESIANS 5:25-27

²⁵ Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her ²⁶ to make her holy, cleansing her by the washing with water through the word, ²⁷ and to present her to himself as a radiant church, without stain or wrinkle or any other blemish, but holy and blameless.

REVELATION 19:6-7

⁶ Then I heard what sounded like a great multitude, like the roar of rushing waters and like loud peals of thunder, shouting:

“Hallelujah!

For our Lord God Almighty reigns.

⁷ Let us rejoice and be glad
and give him glory!

For the wedding of the Lamb has come,
and his bride has made herself ready.

EPHESIANS 5:25–27 / REVELATION 19:6–7 · IN SHORT

As a church, we are the Bride of Christ. Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her, to make her holy and to present her to himself radiant. At the wedding of the Lamb, His bride has made herself ready.

1 CORINTHIANS 11:2–4 · NIV

² I praise you for remembering me in everything and for holding to the traditions just as I passed them on to you. ³ But I want you to realize that the head of every man is Christ, and the head of the woman is man, and the head of Christ is God. ⁴ Every man who prays or prophesies with his head covered dishonors his head.

IN SHORT

Christ over man, man over woman, and God over Christ. He also says that a man who prays or prophesies with his head covered dishonors his head.

Why does Scripture describe the Church as the Bride of Christ?**READ EPHESIANS 5:25–27****UNDERSTAND**

This shows how precious the Church is to Jesus. He loves her, cares for her, and is preparing her. If the Church is the Bride of Christ, then faithfulness matters: keeping Christ first, rejecting compromise, pursuing holiness, remaining faithful to Him.

SCRIPTURE

THE HOPE OF THE CHURCH

JOHN 14:1-3 · NIV

¹ “Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God; believe also in me. ² My Father’s house has many rooms; if that were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you? ³ And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and take you to be with me that you also may be where I am.

JOHN 14:1-3 · IN SHORT

Jesus tells His disciples to trust Him, for He is preparing a place for them and will return to bring them to be with Him.

1 THESSALONIANS 4:16-18 · NIV

¹⁶ For the Lord himself will come down from heaven, with a loud command, with the voice of the archangel and with the trumpet call of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first. ¹⁷ After that, we who are still alive and are left will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And so we will be with the Lord forever. ¹⁸ Therefore encourage one another with these words.

IN SHORT

The Lord will return, the dead in Christ will rise, and believers will be gathered to be with Him forever. This is meant to encourage us.

UNDERSTAND

The Church does not live only for the present. We live with hope. Jesus has not forgotten His people. This gives believers comfort in suffering, faithfulness in waiting, confidence in God's promises, and hope beyond this world.

KEY TRUTH

The Church is not abandoned. The Church is awaited.

REFLECT

ANSWER HONESTLY

How do I truly view the Church?

Do I see the Church as Christ’s body, God’s family, and the Bride of Christ?

Am I functioning faithfully as part of the body?

Do I serve, love, and protect the unity of the Church?

Am I remaining faithful to Christ?

CHALLENGE

- Value the Church the way God values the Church.
- Refuse division.
- Love other believers.
- Use your gifts to serve.
- Stay faithful to Christ.
- Live with the hope of His return.

PRAYER

Lord,

Thank You for Your Church. Teach me to value what
You value.

Help me to love Your people, serve faithfully, protect unity,
and remain true to Christ. Let my life strengthen Your body
and honor You.

Amen.

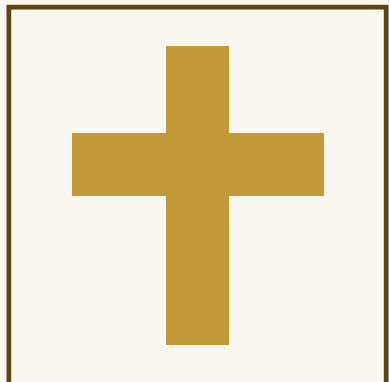
DATE OF THIS STUDY**STUDIED WITH**

CROSS

Learning to Hate Sin and Love God Through
Jesus' Sacrifice

PURPOSE

To hate sin and love God because we
appreciate Jesus' sacrifice.



PURPOSE

To hate sin and love God because we appreciate Jesus' sacrifice.

MAIN QUESTION

How would you define sacrifice?
Who would you die for?

INTRO

The Cross is the foundation of Christianity. Sin hurts both God and us. Jesus was fully God and fully human, and He experienced real sorrow, struggle, pain, rejection, and suffering.

This lesson will help us see what Jesus endured, how people responded to Him, and what our response to the Cross should be.

But the question is: **How do you truly view the Cross?**

YOUR ANSWER**BEFORE WE OPEN THE BIBLE**

How would you define sacrifice?

Who would you die for?

Hold both answers next to each other. The first one is a definition. The second one is a list — and it is almost always short.

LEADER'S NOTE

Nobody puts a stranger on that list. That is the whole distance this lesson has to cover: Romans 5:8 says Christ died for us while we were still sinners.

SCRIPTURE

GETHSEMANE

MATTHEW 26:31-35 • NIV

³¹ Then Jesus told them, “This very night you will all fall away on account of me, for it is written:

“I will strike the shepherd,
and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.’

³² But after I have risen, I will go ahead of you into Galilee.”

³³ Peter replied, “Even if all fall away on account of you, I never will.”

³⁴ “Truly I tell you,” Jesus answered, “this very night, before the rooster crows, you will disown me three times.”

³⁵ But Peter declared, “Even if I have to die with you, I will never disown you.” And all the other disciples said the same.

MATTHEW 26:31-35 • IN SHORT

Jesus told His disciples they would all fall away that night, and He told Peter he would deny Him three times. In Gethsemane, Jesus was deeply troubled and prayed three times, submitting to the Father's will. Meanwhile, the disciples kept falling asleep instead of watching and praying. Finally, Jesus said the time had come for Him to be betrayed.

What would make you stop following Jesus? How would you feel if your closest friends failed you in your hardest moment?

READ MATTHEW 26:31-46**UNDERSTAND**

- Jesus did not go to the Cross lightly. He felt the weight of what was coming.
- Obedience can involve deep struggle, and prayer gave Jesus strength to endure.
- Jesus did not simply die. He chose to surrender Himself to the will of the Father.

SCRIPTURE

ARRESTED, AND DESERTED

MATTHEW 26:47-68 • NIV

⁴⁷ While he was still speaking, Judas, one of the Twelve, arrived. With him was a large crowd armed with swords and clubs, sent from the chief priests and the elders of the people. ⁴⁸ Now the betrayer had arranged a signal with them: “The one I kiss is the man; arrest him.” ⁴⁹ Going at once to Jesus, Judas said, “Greetings, Rabbi!” and kissed him.

⁵⁰ Jesus replied, “Do what you came for, friend.”

Then the men stepped forward, seized Jesus and arrested him. ⁵¹

With that, one of Jesus’ companions reached for his sword, drew it out and struck the servant of the high priest, cutting off his ear.

⁵² “Put your sword back in its place,” Jesus said to him, “for all who draw the sword will die by the sword. ⁵³ Do you think I cannot call on my Father, and he will at once put at my disposal more than twelve legions of angels? ⁵⁴ But how then would the Scriptures be fulfilled that say it must happen in this way?”

⁵⁵ In that hour Jesus said to the crowd, “Am I leading a rebellion, that you have come out with swords and clubs to capture me? Every day I sat in the temple courts teaching, and you did not arrest me. ⁵⁶ But this has all taken place that the writings of the prophets might be fulfilled.” Then all the disciples deserted him and fled.

⁵⁷ Those who had arrested Jesus took him to Caiaphas the high priest, where the teachers of the law and the elders had assembled.

⁵⁸ But Peter followed him at a distance, right up to the courtyard of the high priest. He entered and sat down with the guards to see the outcome.

SCRIPTURE

ARRESTED, AND DESERTED · CONT.

MATTHEW 26:47-68 · NIV, CONTINUED

⁵⁹ The chief priests and the whole Sanhedrin were looking for false evidence against Jesus so that they could put him to death. ⁶⁰ But they did not find any, though many false witnesses came forward.

Finally two came forward ⁶¹ and declared, “This fellow said, ‘I am able to destroy the temple of God and rebuild it in three days.’”

⁶² Then the high priest stood up and said to Jesus, “Are you not going to answer? What is this testimony that these men are bringing against you?” ⁶³ But Jesus remained silent.

The high priest said to him, “I charge you under oath by the living God: Tell us if you are the Messiah, the Son of God.”

⁶⁴ “You have said so,” Jesus replied. “But I say to all of you: From now on you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of the Mighty One and coming on the clouds of heaven.”

⁶⁵ Then the high priest tore his clothes and said, “He has spoken blasphemy! Why do we need any more witnesses? Look, now you have heard the blasphemy. ⁶⁶ What do you think?”

“He is worthy of death,” they answered.

⁶⁷ Then they spit in his face and struck him with their fists.

Others slapped him ⁶⁸ and said, “Prophecy to us, Messiah. Who hit you?”

MATTHEW 26:47-68 • IN SHORT

Judas came with an armed crowd and betrayed Jesus with a kiss, and Jesus was arrested. When one disciple tried to defend Him with a sword, Jesus stopped him and said this had to happen to fulfill Scripture. All the disciples then deserted Him and fled. Jesus was taken before the high priest and the Sanhedrin, where false witnesses accused Him. When asked if He was the Messiah, Jesus answered boldly, and they condemned Him to death, mocked Him, spat on Him, and struck Him.

UNDERSTAND

Jesus had the power to escape, but He chose the Cross. His suffering was voluntary, His arrest was not weakness, and His love was intentional.

Peter followed, but from a distance. How does that relate to you?

READ MATTHEW 26:58

THREE RESPONSES

TO THE CROSS

PETER — MATTHEW 26:69–75

Peter denied Jesus. Out of fear, he disowned Him, but afterward he was deeply broken and wept bitterly.

SHOWS

Cowardice, but also godly sorrow.

JUDAS — MATTHEW 27:1–10

Judas betrayed Jesus, realized his sin, but gave in to worldly sorrow and took his own life.

SHOWS

Betrayal and worldly sorrow.

LEADER'S NOTE

Both men failed in the same week and both were sorry. The difference was not the size of the sin — it was what their sorrow drove them to do next. Keep that distinction available; it is the point of the next page.

THREE RESPONSES

TO THE CROSS

PILATE — MATTHEW 27:11–26

Pilate failed to stand for what was right. His indecision was still a decision, and he cared more about people's opinions than God's truth.

SHOWS

Indecision and fear of people.

KEY TRUTH

The Cross forces every person to respond. No response is also a response.

Which response are you most like: Peter, Judas, or Pilate?

READ MATTHEW 27:11–26

SCRIPTURE

THE CRUCIFIXION

MATTHEW 27:27-56 • NIV

²⁷ Then the governor's soldiers took Jesus into the Praetorium and gathered the whole company of soldiers around him. ²⁸ They stripped him and put a scarlet robe on him, ²⁹ and then twisted together a crown of thorns and set it on his head. They put a staff in his right hand. Then they knelt in front of him and mocked him. "Hail, king of the Jews!" they said. ³⁰ They spit on him, and took the staff and struck him on the head again and again. ³¹ After they had mocked him, they took off the robe and put his own clothes on him. Then they led him away to crucify him. ³² As they were going out, they met a man from Cyrene, named Simon, and they forced him to carry the cross. ³³ They came to a place called Golgotha (which means "the place of the skull"). ³⁴ There they offered Jesus wine to drink, mixed with gall; but after tasting it, he refused to drink it. ³⁵ When they had crucified him, they divided up his clothes by casting lots. ³⁶ And sitting down, they kept watch over him there. ³⁷ Above his head they placed the written charge against him: THIS IS JESUS, THE KING OF THE JEWS.

³⁸ Two rebels were crucified with him, one on his right and one on his left. ³⁹ Those who passed by hurled insults at him, shaking their heads ⁴⁰ and saying, "You who are going to destroy the temple and build it in three days, save yourself! Come down from the cross, if you are the Son of God!" ⁴¹ In the same way the chief priests, the teachers of the law and the elders mocked him. ⁴² "He saved others," they said, "but he can't save himself! He's the king of Israel! Let him come down now from the cross, and we will believe in him. ⁴³ He trusts in God. Let God rescue him now if he wants him, for he said, 'I am the Son of God.'" ⁴⁴ In the same way the rebels who were crucified with him also heaped insults on him.

SCRIPTURE

THE CRUCIFIXION · CONT.

MATTHEW 27:27-56 · NIV, CONTINUED

⁴⁵ From noon until three in the afternoon darkness came over all the land. ⁴⁶ About three in the afternoon Jesus cried out in a loud voice, “Eli, Eli, lema sabachthani?” (which means “My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?”).

⁴⁷ When some of those standing there heard this, they said, “He’s calling Elijah.”

⁴⁸ Immediately one of them ran and got a sponge. He filled it with wine vinegar, put it on a staff, and offered it to Jesus to drink. ⁴⁹ The rest said, “Now leave him alone. Let’s see if Elijah comes to save him.”

⁵⁰ And when Jesus had cried out again in a loud voice, he gave up his spirit.

⁵¹ At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom. The earth shook, the rocks split ⁵² and the tombs broke open. The bodies of many holy people who had died were raised to life. ⁵³ They came out of the tombs after Jesus’ resurrection and went into the holy city and appeared to many people.

⁵⁴ When the centurion and those with him who were guarding Jesus saw the earthquake and all that had happened, they were terrified, and exclaimed, “Surely he was the Son of God!”

⁵⁵ Many women were there, watching from a distance. They had followed Jesus from Galilee to care for his needs. ⁵⁶ Among them were Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James and Joseph, and the mother of Zebedee’s sons.

MATTHEW 27:27-56 • IN SHORT

The soldiers mocked Jesus, put a robe and crown of thorns on Him, and led Him away to be crucified. At Golgotha, Jesus was crucified, mocked by the crowd, religious leaders, and even the rebels beside Him. Darkness covered the land, and Jesus cried out before giving up His spirit. At His death, the temple curtain was torn, the earth shook, and many were terrified. Seeing all this, the centurion declared that Jesus truly was the Son of God.

UNDERSTAND

The Cross shows both the seriousness of sin and the greatness of God's love. Jesus suffered publicly, painfully, willingly, and in our place.

KEY TRUTH

He took what we deserved so that we could receive what only He could give.

SCRIPTURE

HE BECAME SIN FOR US

2 CORINTHIANS 5:21 • NIV

²¹ God made him who had no sin to be sin for us, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.

IN SHORT

Jesus became sin for us so that we might become the righteousness of God.

UNDERSTAND

This is the exchange at the centre of the Cross. He took our guilt, and gave us a standing before God that was never ours to earn. Nothing in the trade was fair, and none of it was accidental.

How do you personally respond to hurt, pain, or suffering?

READ 2 CORINTHIANS 5:21

SCRIPTURE

THE CROSS IS NOT THE END

MATTHEW 27:57-66 • NIV

⁵⁷ As evening approached, there came a rich man from Arimathea, named Joseph, who had himself become a disciple of Jesus. ⁵⁸ Going to Pilate, he asked for Jesus' body, and Pilate ordered that it be given to him. ⁵⁹ Joseph took the body, wrapped it in a clean linen cloth, ⁶⁰ and placed it in his own new tomb that he had cut out of the rock. He rolled a big stone in front of the entrance to the tomb and went away.

⁶¹ Mary Magdalene and the other Mary were sitting there opposite the tomb.

⁶² The next day, the one after Preparation Day, the chief priests and the Pharisees went to Pilate. ⁶³ "Sir," they said, "we remember that while he was still alive that deceiver said, 'After three days I will rise again.' ⁶⁴ So give the order for the tomb to be made secure until the third day. Otherwise, his disciples may come and steal the body and tell the people that he has been raised from the dead. This last deception will be worse than the first."

⁶⁵ "Take a guard," Pilate answered. "Go, make the tomb as secure as you know how." ⁶⁶ So they went and made the tomb secure by putting a seal on the stone and posting the guard.

SCRIPTURE

HE HAS RISEN

MATTHEW 28:1-10 · NIV

- ¹ After the Sabbath, at dawn on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went to look at the tomb.
- ² There was a violent earthquake, for an angel of the Lord came down from heaven and, going to the tomb, rolled back the stone and sat on it. ³ His appearance was like lightning, and his clothes were white as snow. ⁴ The guards were so afraid of him that they shook and became like dead men.
- ⁵ The angel said to the women, “Do not be afraid, for I know that you are looking for Jesus, who was crucified. ⁶ He is not here; he has risen, just as he said. Come and see the place where he lay. ⁷ Then go quickly and tell his disciples: ‘He has risen from the dead and is going ahead of you into Galilee. There you will see him.’ Now I have told you.”
- ⁸ So the women hurried away from the tomb, afraid yet filled with joy, and ran to tell his disciples. ⁹ Suddenly Jesus met them. “Greetings,” he said. They came to him, clasped his feet and worshiped him. ¹⁰ Then Jesus said to them, “Do not be afraid. Go and tell my brothers to go to Galilee; there they will see me.”

MATTHEW 27:57-66 · IN SHORT

Joseph of Arimathea, a disciple of Jesus, asked for His body, wrapped it, and placed it in his own new tomb. Mary Magdalene and the other Mary stayed near the tomb. The chief priests and Pharisees then secured the tomb with a seal and posted guards to prevent anyone from stealing Jesus' body.

MATTHEW 28:1-10 · IN SHORT

Jesus rose from the dead and appeared to His disciples.

UNDERSTAND

Jesus was truly buried. Jesus truly rose again. The resurrection confirms His victory over sin, His victory over death, and His identity as Lord.

Without the resurrection, the Cross would only be a tragedy. Because of the resurrection, it is our hope.

SCRIPTURE

WHAT SIN COST HIM

ISAIAH 53:4-6 · NIV

⁴ Surely he took up our pain
and bore our suffering,
yet we considered him punished by God,
stricken by him, and afflicted.

⁵ But he was pierced for our transgressions,
he was crushed for our iniquities;
the punishment that brought us peace was on him,
and by his wounds we are healed.

⁶ We all, like sheep, have gone astray,
each of us has turned to our own way;
and the Lord has laid on him
the iniquity of us all.

ISAIAH 53:4–6 · IN SHORT

Our sins made us responsible for Jesus' suffering. We should take sin seriously because of what it cost Him.

1 PETER 2:21–24 · NIV

²¹ To this you were called, because Christ suffered for you, leaving you an example, that you should follow in his steps.

²² “He committed no sin,
and no deceit was found in his mouth.”

²³ When they hurled their insults at him, he did not retaliate; when he suffered, he made no threats. Instead, he entrusted himself to him who judges justly. ²⁴ “He himself bore our sins” in his body on the cross, so that we might die to sins and live for righteousness; “by his wounds you have been healed.”

IN SHORT

Jesus suffered for each of us personally. We are called to die to sin and live for righteousness.

The Cross is not only something to admire. It is something that should change us. The right response is gratitude, confession, repentance, and a desire to live differently.

What is the hardest sin you need to surrender?

READ ISAIAH 53:4–6

REFLECT**ANSWER HONESTLY**

What does the Cross reveal about my sin?

Do I truly hate my sin because of how it hurt Jesus?

Am I following Jesus closely, or only at a distance?

Am I more like Peter, Judas, or Pilate?

What is one sin I need to confess and surrender?

CHALLENGE

- Die to sin and live for righteousness.
- Respond to the Cross with gratitude.
- Take time for honest confession.
- Develop a clear plan for repentance.
- Choose a faithful response to Jesus.

PRAYER

Lord Jesus,

Thank You for Your sacrifice on the Cross. Help me never to treat sin lightly.

Teach me to hate what separates me from You and to love You more because of what You have done for me. Give me a broken heart, true repentance, and a life that honors Your sacrifice.

Amen.

DATE OF THIS STUDY**STUDIED WITH**

CLOSING**CLOSING REFLECTION**

As you finish this guide, take time to reflect honestly before God.

What have you learned about Him?

What truth has challenged you the most?

What area of your life needs surrender or change?

What step of obedience is God asking from you now?

Following Jesus is not only about gaining knowledge. It is about responding to His truth with faith, repentance, obedience, and love.

Do not rush past what God may be doing in your heart. **Pause. Pray. Reflect. Respond.**

OTHER REFLECTION QUESTIONS

What is God teaching me?

What must I change?

What is my next step?

NEXT

NEXT STEPS

ACTS 2:41–42 • NIV

⁴¹ Those who accepted his message were baptized, and about three thousand were added to their number that day. ⁴² They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching and to fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer.

If you have gone through this guide and are ready to follow Jesus more fully, do not stop here.

If you believe you are ready to take this step, we encourage you to speak with a pastor or church leader. Share what God has been teaching you, ask your questions, and express your readiness to be baptized.

You may also take these next steps:

- Continue reading the Bible daily.
- Pray and seek God consistently.
- Join the church in worship and fellowship.
- Stay connected with other believers.
- Speak with a pastor or leader about your spiritual journey.
- Show your readiness to obey Christ in water baptism.

This guide is only the beginning. Keep growing in faith, truth, obedience, and love.

INDEX

SCRIPTURE INDEX

Every passage used in this guide, in Bible order, with the page it appears on. Roman numerals refer to the introduction.

PSALM	
119:1-2	4
ISAIAH	
53:4-6	121
JEREMIAH	
29:11-13	11
EZEKIEL	
18:20	80
MATTHEW	
3:1-2	51
4:17	51
6:25-34	5
7:7-8	14
15:6-9	80
16:13-19	55
22:34-40	43
26:31-35	107
26:47-68	109
26:69-75	112
27:1-10	112
27:11-26	113
27:27-56	114
27:57-66	118
28:1-10	119
28:18-20	35

MARK	
1:16-18	37
7:1-13	25
9:1	52
LUKE	
9:23-26	38
11:1-4	41
14:25-33	39
17:20-21	53
18:16-17	80
23:50-52	61
JOHN	
3:1-7	54
3:5	78
4:23-24	10
8:31-32	24
12:48	28
13:34-35	44
14:1-3	99

INDEX

SCRIPTURE INDEX · CONTINUED

ACTS

2:1–4 58

2:22–24 73

2:36–41 59

2:37 74

2:38 60

2:38–42 75

2:41–42 127

2:42 i

8:26–39 12

11:25–26 36

17:10–11 26

17:24–28 8

ROMANS

3:23 71

3:25 78

6:3–8 76

6:23 57

1 CORINTHIANS

11:2–4 98

12:12–14 91

12:15–22 92

12:23–28 94

2 CORINTHIANS

5:21 117

EPHESIANS

2:19–22 96

5:25–27 97

COLOSSIANS

1:15–18 90

2:11–12 79

1 THESSALONIANS

4:16–18 100

1 TIMOTHY

4:16 26

2 TIMOTHY

3:16–17 22

HEBREWS

4:12–13 23

JAMES

1:22–25 27

1 PETER

2:9–10 69

2:21–24 122

3:18–22 82

2 PETER

1:19–21 24

1 JOHN

1:3–4 61

REVELATION

3:20 81

19:6–7 97

ACTS 242 CHURCH OF CHRIST

They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching and to fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer.

ACTS 2:42

VISIT US

4707 Dr Arcadio Santos Ave

Parañaque, 1700 Metro Manila

acts242churchofchrist.com

Service times, location, and lessons online



SCAN TO CONNECT

TO GOD BE THE GLORY

EDITION 1 • 2026